Informed Consent for Pre-Survey

Dear Participant,

We are student researchers in the Bachelor of Science in Information Technology program at Southwestern University-PHINMA. We are conducting this capstone study:

Architecting a Lightweight Cloud-Based Inventory and Financial Management System: A Mixed-Methods Evaluation of Decision-Making Efficiency in Philippine SMEs

The study examines inventory and financial recordkeeping in Philippine small and medium enterprises and evaluates Kodigo, a cloud-based inventory and financial management system.

Purpose and what you will do

You are invited because your work may involve inventory, sales recording, stock counts, reporting, or financial reconciliation. If you agree, you will complete a 25-question pre-survey about your role and current work processes. It should take about 10 to 15 minutes. The questionnaire does not ask for your name, password, or account credentials. You may leave any question unanswered.

Possible risks and benefits

There is no direct benefit promised. Questions about work practices and errors may feel sensitive. You may skip any question and should not include customer names, passwords, or confidential financial details.

Voluntary participation and withdrawal

Taking part is voluntary. You may decline or stop before submitting your questionnaire without penalty or effect on your relationship with the university or your business. Because the survey does not collect a name or unique code, the researchers may be unable to locate and remove a response after it has been submitted.

Privacy and use of information

The signed consent form will be stored separately from the questionnaire. Survey responses will be used for this academic study and reported in summary form without names or business names. The questionnaire asks about your role and work experience; in a small workplace, people familiar with the organization may infer who gave a response from those details. Access to study records will be limited to the research team and academic adviser, and records will be retained and disposed of under university research requirements.

Researcher contacts

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Agreement

I have read or had this form explained to me and had a chance to ask questions. I understand that participation is voluntary, that I may skip questions or stop before submitting, and that a submitted response cannot usually be withdrawn because it is not linked to my name. I freely agree to complete the pre-survey.

Participant name (print, optional): _____

Participant signature: _____ Date: _____